MIL-G-37273A
27 September 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-G-37273
14 July 1975

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

GLOVES, PATIENT EXAMINING AND TREATMENT, PLASTIC, NON-STERILE, COLORED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers three sizes of non-sterile, plastic, disposable, impermeable, light-weight seamless gloves which fit either hand. Gloves shall be suitable for medical use in examinations, diagnostic and therapeutic procedures by physicians, nurses and paramedical personnel.

1.2 Classification. Gloves shall be of the following sizes and colors as specified:

Size 1	Small (Pink).
Size 2	Medium (Blue).
Size 3	Large (Green).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Hq., Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, Code ATM, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105E - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D-882 Tests for Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

U. S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC, (USP)

Pharmacopeia of the United States.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042).

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Glove. The glove shall be fabricated from virgin translucent polyvinyl chloride colored to correspond to the sizes indicated in 1.2.

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3.1.2 Dusting powder. Gloves shall be uniformly prepowdered on the interior only with a minimum of absorbable dusting powder meeting the following requirements: Powder shall be a white, odorless powder and shall be in accordance with the tests, standards, and requirements of the Pharmacopeia of the United States (USP) for Absorbable Dusting Powder.

3.2 Style and design. The patient examining gloves shall be constructed in one piece, free of seams and welts, and shall have a smooth finish. Shall be a five-fingered glove suitable for use on either hand. A small continuous bead shall be formed on the glove circumference at the cuff end to prevent tearing. The glove shall be constructed to provide maximum tactility in use, and have straight or curved, well-fitting fingers that permit maximum freedom of movement. The palm section shall be of sufficient width to permit comfortable flexing of the hands.

* 3.2.1 Dimensions. The gloves shall have the dimensions in inches as indicated in table I.

TABLE I. Glove dimensions.

Characteristic	Size 1	Size 2	Size 3
Overall length	9 1/	9-5/8	9-5/8
Width at wrist (flattened)	3-7/16	4-1/8	4-9/16
Width across palm at base thumb (flattened)	4-1/4 to 4-5/8	5-1/8 to 5-1/4	5-1/2 to 5-3/4
Length of thumb	2	2-1/8	2-5/16
Length of index finger	2-7/16	2-3/4	2-3/4
Length of middle finger	2-1/2	3-1/8	3-3/16
Length of ring finger	2-3/8	2-13/16	2-7/8
Length of little finger	2	2-1/8	2-9/16
Width of thumb (flattened) at base	1-1/8	1-1/2	1-9/16
Width of thumb 3/4 inch below tip	1-1/8	1-7/16	1-7/16
Width of index finger (flattened) at base	1-1/16	1-3/8	1-7/16
Width of index finger 3/4 inch below tip	1	1-3/16	1-1/4
Width of middle finger (flattened) at base	1-1/8	1-5/16	1-1/2
Width of middle finger 3/4 inch from tip	1-1/16	1-3/16	1-5/16
Width of ring finger (flattened) at base	1-1/16	1-5/16	1-3/8

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TABLE I. Glove dimension, (cont'd)

Characteristic	Size 1	Size 2	Size 3
Width of ring finger 3/4 inch from tip	1	1-1/8	1-1/4
Width of little finger (flattened) at base	1	1-3/16	1-1/4
Width of little finger 3/4 inch from tip	15/16	1-1/16	1-1/16
Thickness at 1/2 inch from finger tips	.0035	.0035	.0035

1/ Tolerances unless otherwise indicated are as follows:

Up to 1 inch	± 1/8
1 to 2 inches	± 3/16
Above 3 inches	± 5/16
Decimals	± .001

3.3 Physical requirements. The gloves shall comply with the physical requirements contained in table II. Tests for physical requirements shall be conducted as specified in 4.4.1.

TABLE II. Physical requirements

Characteristics	Values
Tensile strength - pounds per square inch	1300 min.
Breaking strength - pounds per inch of width	5.2 min.
Percentage elongation at break	300 min.

3.4 Freedom from pinholes. The glove shall be supplied free of pinholes, and when tested as specified in 4.4.2 the glove shall not leak.

3.5 Finish. The glove shall have a visually dull but smooth-to-the touch exterior, and visually glossy and smooth-to-the touch interior surface. The glove shall be free from holes, visible ingrained particles, tackiness, bloom, strings, bleeding, and other imperfections.

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3.6 Low temperature flexibility. The glove shall not crack at 20 degrees Fahrenheit (°F) when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.7 High temperature exposure. The glove shall withstand exposure at 155°F for 72 hours without evidence of tackiness, plasticizer exudation, or other deterioration when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Gloves shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality for the dusting powder, supplied by the manufacturer of the dusting powder, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the name of the dusting powder, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table III. The unit of product for examination shall be one glove.

TABLE III. Sampling for examination.

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective) 1/
Major	S-3	2.5
Minor	S-2	4.0

1/ If acceptance number is not exceeded, lot shall be accepted. If rejection number is equalled or exceeded, inspection at level II may be performed to determine final rejection or acceptance.

4.2.2 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and in accordance with table IV.

TABLE IV. Sampling for tests.

Characteristic	Unit of product	Requirement	Test procedure	Insp. level	AQL(percent defective) 1/
Tensile strength	Glove	3.3	4.4.1	S-3 2/	2.5
Percentage elongation	Glove	3.3	4.4.1	S-3	2.5
Freedom from pinholes	Glove	3.4	4.4.2	S-3	2.5
Low temperature flexibility	Glove	3.6	4.4.3	S-1	2.5
High temperature exposure	Glove	3.7	4.4.4	S-1	2.5

1/ If rejection number is equalled or exceeded, inspection at level II may be performed to determine final rejection or acceptance.

2/ Tensile strength shall be run on a minimum of 10 gloves.

4.2.3 Sample unit usage. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for determination of two or more test characteristics.

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4.3 Examination. The gloves shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables III and V, and in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table V. Any glove in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected (defective) and if the number of defective gloves in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected (see 4.3.1).

TABLE V. Classification of defects.

Categories		Defects
Critical:		None defined.
Major:		
	101	Tears, large holes.
	102	Large, open blisters.
	103	Imbedded particles.
	104	Excessively thin spots (under 0.002 inch).
	105	Tackiness.
	106	Pinholes.
	107	Gloves adhering to each other.
	108	Gloves not having a small continuous bead at the cuff end.
	109	Foreign matter present.
Minor:		
	201	Fingertips over 0.0045 inch thick.
	202	Palm thickness over 0.006 inch.
	203	Wrist thickness over 0.008 inch.
	204	Short, gloves under specified length.
	205	Excessive blisters that would interfere with accepted professional use (cluster of small blisters as contrasted with large open blisters.)
	206	Bloom, bleeding, strings, and other imperfections.

4.3.1 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table VI. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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101 Tears and large holes

TABLE VI. Examination of preparation for delivery.

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Physical requirements shall be conducted in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials, Method D-882.

4.4.2 Pinhole test. Gloves shall be filled with 300 milliliters of water and held suspended from the cuff end for 5 minutes. Gloves shall be examined for leaks.

4.4.3 Low temperature flexibility. The glove shall be placed on a wooden rack and exposed in a low temperature cabinet so that it is at a temperature of -20F for a minimum of 1/2 hour. It shall then be manipulated with a dowel stick, or other non-conductive rod, to determine if it will flex without cracking.

4.4.4 High temperature exposure. The glove shall be exposed in a mechanical convection oven for 72 hours at 165°F. Upon removal and cooling of the glove, it shall be examined for exudation, tackiness or other deterioration.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing fifty (50) gloves as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1.1 Unit package. Each unit of issue (fifty 50 gloves) shall be packaged in a suitable dispensing container. Gloves shall be packaged flat. Closure of container shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.1.2 Level C. Each unit of issue shall be packaged in standard commercial container of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Twenty (20) units of issue shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Closure, waterproofing and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty (20) units of issue shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Units of issue shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking. Each unit package and exterior container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

* 6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number and date of this specification.
(b) Size (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Applicable NSN.

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6.2 NSN coverage. This specification covers the following patient examining gloves appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6515-00-149-1618	GLOVES, PATIENT EXAMINING AND TREATMENT, Plastic, Disposable, Nonsterile, Small Size (Pink), 50s
6515-00-149-1619	GLOVES, PATIENT EXAMINING AND TREATMENT, Plastic, Disposable, Nonsterile, Medium Size (Blue), 50s
6515-00-149-1620	GLOVES, PATIENT EXAMINING AND TREATMENT, Plastic, Disposable, Nonsterile, Large Size, (Green), 50s

It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

6.3 Changes. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DH

Project No. 6515-2005

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OMB Approval
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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-G-37273A GLOVES, PATIENT EXAMINING AND TREATMENT, PLASTIC,

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER NON-STERILE, COLORED

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

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